

Chapter 186 Part 1: Extra Story 9-1

(Timeline does not overlap with previous chapter)

Another winter had arrived.

The snow fell late this year, but when it came, it was heavy—as if making up for all the previous deficit.

The snow began falling at midnight, and by morning, a thick layer had accumulated, almost reaching ankle height.

Approaching noon, there was still no sign of it stopping.

Chaochao and Mumu had started boarding at school once they entered high school. They only needed to be picked up from school at 6 PM when they had their weekly break.

So Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu were finally having their world of two again after many years.

Because of the heavy snow, Xu Qingzhu didn't go out to work and handled some matters in the study.

Liang Shi had also just finished filming a drama and was in her rest period. She read for a while in the living room, and as mealtime approached, the two of them tacitly agreed to have hot pot.

To better enjoy the scenery, the two moved their dining spot to the balcony.

Outside the huge floor-to-ceiling windows, white snow drifted down. The entire world was wrapped in silver, appearing beautiful and serene.

Liang Shi neatly arranged the delivered food, then went to the kitchen to prepare two bowls of dipping sauce.

She had originally planned to just put the hot pot base directly in to cook, but after taking out the hot pot base, she felt it wasn't quite right. Driven by her perfectionism, she went and stir-fried the base first, and the fragrance of hot pot immediately filled the house.

There was no heating on the balcony, so Liang Shi brought two blankets, and also cracked the window open a small gap.

The steamy heat dissipated outward with the wind.

An ordinary hot pot meal became extraordinary because of this heavy snow.

Liang Shi also opened a very expensive bottle of wine from the wine cabinet.

By the time Xu Qingzhu came out of the study, everything was ready.

The atmosphere was perfect.

Xu Qingzhu sat in the rattan chair and accidentally reclined all the way back, laughing as she teased: "How am I supposed to eat like this?"

"I'll get you a different chair." Liang Shi stood up, but Xu Qingzhu didn't want that and got up herself to switch to one from the living room.

With just the two of them at home, both familiar with each other's eating habits, they ate in perfect sync.

After eating and drinking their fill, the two switched to the rattan chairs and sat on the balcony watching the snow.

Snowflakes drifted and swirled, like feathers fluttering through the air.

Xu Qingzhu rested with her eyes half-closed, suddenly saying with emotion: "It seems like Haizhou City hasn't had such heavy snow in a long time."

"Is that so?" Liang Shi agreed, "I don't recall seeing such heavy snow either."

Although Haizhou City was in the north, it didn't get much precipitation. In winter, there would occasionally be some snow, but never this heavy.

At least Liang Shi hadn't seen anything like it in all these years.

"The last time I saw snow this heavy was when I was in university." Xu Qingzhu said: "I remember almost freezing my calves off going to the supermarket to buy things."

Liang Shi laughed softly: "Then why did you still go?"

"To see the snow, I suppose."

After saying this, Xu Qingzhu dozed off with her eyes closed, her breathing gradually becoming even.

The temperature inside was just right, and the scenery outside was beautiful. Listening to Xu Qingzhu's even breathing, Liang Shi also slowly drifted off to sleep.

The white snow blurred her vision. Liang Shi felt herself falling into an environment full of thick fog and white snow.

She reached out her hand but couldn't see it—she could only feel the icy coldness.

Liang Shi withdrew her hand.

Then the thick fog dispersed, white was replaced by color, and this colorful world appeared.

But this world was also a blanket of white, because of the heavy snow.

The snow had fallen extremely thick, already past people's calves.

Someone lay motionless face-down in the snow, as if they had fainted. Liang Shi walked up to her and reached out to help her up, but her hand passed through the person's body.

The person seemed to be dead, and everyone passing by kept their distance.

Liang Shi called out: "Wake up."

Only the echo of her own voice reached her ears.

The other person couldn't hear her speak.

Liang Shi looked around and slowly recognized the place—this was Qingyi University.

Many of the surrounding buildings were covered in white snow, and they were more worn than the current Qingyi University, so it wasn't immediately recognizable.

Passersby came and went.

Liang Shi couldn't actually feel the cold, but seeing the sky full of white snow, she unconsciously rubbed her arms.

After quite a while, a girl wearing a white down jacket and white scarf passed by that "corpse." After walking past, she suddenly stopped, slowly turned around, thought for two seconds, then walked back and placed the cup of milk tea in her hand near the "corpse."

The moment the milk tea was set down, the snow immediately melted in a ring around it.

The girl's voice was very low, and Liang Shi couldn't hear what she said.

But after the girl left, that "corpse" suddenly sat up, face covered in snow, features indiscernible.

She stared at the girl's retreating figure for a long time, then raised her hand and brushed her face, clearing away all the snow to reveal that face.

It was a face identical to Liang Shi's.

She held the milk tea in her palm, poked it open and took a sip, then suddenly smiled.

Liang Shi followed her figure as she left Qingyi University, and heard that detestable voice again.

Qiu Zimin said on the phone: "A-Shi, come home to stay."

After returning, that room was dark, stuffy, suffocating.

And in the unlit room, with just a pencil, she drew the graceful figure she had seen during the day.

Especially that smile.

A smile that was shy yet carried a hint of sunshine.

Light and shadow shifted.

The surroundings suddenly turned white, but then quickly changed again.

In a piano room, someone sat backlit, playing the piano.

She wore a white shirt, her black hair reaching her shoulders. Above the piano room flowed her music, gentle as water.

Chapter 186 Part 2: Extra Story 9-2

Liang Shi stood at the doorway waiting for a while, and soon someone came over.

A woman in a blue long dress walked to the piano room entrance holding a sunflower, standing shoulder to shoulder with Liang Shi—except she couldn't see Liang Shi.

But Liang Shi could observe her carefully.

The woman looked to be in her thirties, carrying a niche luxury designer bag, holding a yellow sunflower in her hand. When she looked at the person playing the piano, her eyes were full of love.

Soon, the piano music stopped.

The person playing turned around—it was a face identical to Liang Shi's.

However, the last time Liang Shi had seen her, that face still carried a hint of hostility.

Now it was peaceful and gentle.

She looked toward the doorway and said something in a low voice.

Then the woman walked over, throwing herself straight into her arms.

The two of them left the piano room shoulder to shoulder, sunlight falling upon them.

Liang Shi stared at their retreating figures for a long time, when suddenly someone was gently calling her by her ear: "Wife."

Only then did Liang Shi wake up. The moment she opened her eyes, she saw Xu Qingzhu's face.

Liang Shi smiled softly and raised her hand to touch her back, but Xu Qingzhu asked: "Did you have a nightmare?"

Liang Shi shook her head: "Not really."

She had actually dreamed of the original owner.

The other person had also met a lover in another world and was living well.

Something no one would have ever expected.

It's just that she missed her grandpa and grandma a bit.

Just now, in that instant.

"Did I talk in my sleep?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingzhu shook her head: "No. You were crying."

As she spoke, she raised her hand to wipe the corner of Liang Shi's eye—traces of moist tears.

"Maybe I was moved." Liang Shi said.

The snow outside was still falling.

Although she had seen many things in the dream, Liang Shi had only slept for about ten minutes in reality.

Liang Shi pulled Xu Qingzhu into the rattan chair to lie together. The two of them were a bit cramped, but nestled together under the same blanket, they appeared extremely intimate.

"Do you remember what you did that day when it snowed heavily?" Liang Shi suddenly asked Xu Qingzhu.

"Which day?" Xu Qingzhu was puzzled.

"When you were in university." Liang Shi said.

Xu Qingzhu thought for a long time, kept saying there was nothing special.

After chatting idly for a while longer, Xu Qingzhu finally remembered, "That day I think I encountered someone doing performance art at school."

Xu Qingzhu recalled the scene from that day.

Someone was lying in the snow, their hair color very flashy, lying face-down in the snow motionless, like a mannequin.

Many people passing by thought she was crazy.

But Xu Qingzhu had placed a cup of milk tea beside her.

For the Xu Qingzhu of that time, it was just a small thing, long forgotten in the river of memory.

Even now when she recalled it, it was insignificant.

But she didn't know that because of her simple action, she had once influenced half of someone's life.

Xu Qingzhu told Liang Shi everything about her actions that day.

Liang Shi smiled softly without saying anything.

Later, Liang Shi thought that the reason she received those memories that were so precious to the original owner was because the original owner had completely let go.

The other person had met another person worth loving, so she had let go of all these obsessions and memories.

Life seemed to always be like this—constantly missing and meeting.

The following spring, Liang Shi had a sudden idea and drove to the seaside.

She sat alone on the rocks by the sea watching the sunset, feeling the sea breeze. When it was almost time for Xu Qingzhu to get off work, she sent Xu Qingzhu her location.

Xu Qingzhu brought two cans of chilled cola.

The two of them sat shoulder to shoulder by the sea.

Even though Liang Shi didn't say anything, Xu Qingzhu knew what she was thinking.

Every spring, Liang Shi would go sit by the sea.

For her, not being able to bring her grandpa and grandma to the seaside was her greatest regret.

Xu Qingzhu accompanied her, spending the rest of their lives making up for that regret.

After Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu's marriage was exposed, quite a few production teams tried to send Liang Shi proposals for wife-wife variety shows and couple variety shows, but they were all rejected by Liang Shi's agent despite tremendous pressure.

When production teams found out they couldn't get her on wife-wife variety shows, those marriage observation variety shows came knocking.

Liang Shi didn't want to do variety shows, so she rejected them all.

But there was a slow-paced travel variety show that approached them. At that time, Xu Qingzhu happened to want to travel, so when Liang Shi's agent tentatively mentioned it, Xu Qingzhu nodded in agreement.

So Liang Shi ended up with a slow variety show.

Filming a slow variety show was more fun than life on a drama set, just tiring.

But worth mentioning was that although Xu Qingzhu rarely appeared on shows, because she was confident enough, she was completely at ease on the show. And because her viewpoints were sharp and she was smart and mature, she gained many fans.

Netizens exclaimed: Real couples are still the best CPs!¹

When the production team had the couples participating in the variety show answer quiz questions, Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu always had the highest accuracy rate.

This show not only helped Xu Qingzhu fulfill her wish to travel, but also increased her fame.

After the show ended, Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu even did a joint livestream at home.

On the day of the livestream, Xu Qingzhu turned on the camera first. After greeting the camera, she just sat there without much to do. Since the livestream was done at the production team's request, they had provided a script, but the content wasn't very interesting. Xu Qingzhu only said a few lines from it and stopped. When she discovered the comments section, she started chatting with the viewers.

Comments: Who pursued whom between jiejie and Teacher Liang?

Xu Qingzhu: She pursued me.

Comments: Wow.

Comments: Want to know who has higher status at home?

Xu Qingzhu: Her.

Comments: ? Can't tell at all.

Comments: Does Teacher Liang love jiejie more, or does jiejie love Teacher Liang more?

Xu Qingzhu:It's definitely me who loves her more.

Comments: Are there moments in daily life when you want to strangle each other?

Xu Qingzhu: No, we're usually very loving.

A few seconds later, Liang Shi came in carrying a plate of washed cherries, picking one up and bringing it to Xu Qingzhu's lips.

Xu Qingzhu was reading a comment: "Is Teacher Liang's tongue really that flexible?"

Liang Shi: "....."

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

Comments were flooding in: [What kind of question is this? Can she even answer? Isn't this really speeding?]²

Then Xu Qingzhu glanced at Liang Shi and quickly tied a cherry stem into a knot with the tip of her tongue.

"Teacher Liang is even faster than me." Xu Qingzhu said with a straight face.

Liang Shi: "?"

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1. "CP" refers to "coupling" or shipping pairs. The phrase means that real-life couples make for better romantic pairings to ship than fictional or manufactured ones. ⇐
 2. "高速" (gāosù) means "highway" or "speeding," but in Chinese internet slang, it's used to describe content that's moving too fast into suggestive/adult territory, implying the conversation is getting inappropriate. It's a euphemism suggesting things are getting "too fast" or risqué. ⇐